VENTURE CAPITAL INVESTMENT ANALYSIS

PARTNER PROGRAM RE-REVIEW

ANALYST	Venture Capital Review Committee
DATE	May 2026
STAGE	Post-MVP · Partner Program Active
SECTOR	GriefTech · Consumer SaaS · FamilyTech

9.5

/ 10 — EXCEPTIONAL BUY (UPGRADED)

Concept Stage: 8.0 / 10 MVP Stage: 9.2 / 10 Partner Program: 9.5 / 10

Recommended: Seed Round — $1.5M–$2.0M at $6.0M Pre-Money

$47B	$2.67M	$1.17M	$3.84M
TAM	Subscription ARR (Y2)	Partner Revenue (Y2)	Combined Revenue (Y2)

SECTION 1 | WHAT HAS CHANGED — PARTNER PROGRAM IMPACT REVIEW

Third evaluation of Solace Life. Adding the Partner Referral Revenue Program as a structural upgrade to the business model.

When this committee upgraded Solace Life to 9.2/10 (STRONG BUY) at the MVP re-review stage, we identified two outstanding concerns: (1) the absence of a second revenue stream, and (2) a single-product dependency on subscription conversion. The founder has addressed both comprehensively. Solace Life now operates a dual revenue engine. This re-review assesses the impact on our scoring, valuation, and investment recommendation.

Previous Concern	Status	Notes
Second revenue stream beyond subscriptions	✓ MET	Partner Referral Program active — 5 partner categories, scoring system, user survey integration
Single-product revenue dependency risk	✓ RESOLVED	Subscription + Partner Referral creates two independent growth levers. Neither depends on the other.
Pricing correction ($79/$199 → $49/$149)	✓ CORRECTED	Annual plan $49/yr, Legacy plan $149/yr. Blended ARPU $89 at 60/40 split. Lower price = broader market access.
B2B distribution moat	✓ ESTABLISHED	5 partner verticals active: Estate Attorneys (15%), Financial Planners (12%), Realtors (20%), Senior Living (15%), Tax/CPA (15%)
Provisional patent filing	■ IN PROGRESS	Remains the single outstanding item. Must be filed before close. Non-negotiable.

Key Insight: The Partner Referral Program is not an add-on. It is a structural transformation of the business model. Solace Life is now a platform — not just an app — that earns revenue both from families (subscription) and from professional service providers (referral fees) every time those two groups connect. This dual flywheel is rare at this stage and materially increases the investment quality.

SECTION 2 | PARTNER REFERRAL REVENUE PROGRAM — NEW INCOME STREAM ANALYSIS

A complete second business model operating on the same infrastructure at near-zero marginal cost.

How It Works

Solace Life users, in the course of managing their estate planning and family legacy, naturally require professional services: an estate attorney to draft a will, a realtor to plan a home transition, a financial planner to review beneficiary designations, a CPA to handle tax implications, or a senior living advisor for family members. The platform now connects users with vetted, scored, and certified partners in each category. When a transaction closes, Solace Life earns a referral fee. The user gets a trusted professional. The partner gets a highly qualified, life-event-motivated lead. Everyone wins.

Partner Category	Referral Fee	Avg Transaction Value	Avg Solace Fee/Close	Year 2 Revenue
Estate Attorneys	15%	$5,000–$8,000	~$975	**~$175K**
Realtors	20%	$8,000–$18,000	~$2,600	**~$468K**
Financial Planners	12%	$3,000–$6,000	~$540	**~$97K**
Senior Living Advisors	15%	$4,000–$7,500	~$862	**~$155K**
Tax / CPA	15%	$2,500–$5,000	~$562	**~$101K**
TOTAL (Year 2 — 30K users)			**Blended ~$1,254/close**	**$1.17M**

Partner Quality Assurance — Scoring System

Partners are not simply listed. They are scored on a composite algorithm combining transaction completion rate (30%), user satisfaction (25%), response time (20%), and Net Promoter Score from user surveys (25%). Partners must maintain a minimum composite score to remain in the program. This creates a self-improving quality loop that protects user trust and Solace Life's brand — and gives partners incentive to perform. The scoring system itself is a moat: it takes time and user data to build, and competitors cannot replicate it without the user base.

Program Metric	6 Months	Year 1	Year 2
Active Partner Categories	5	5	5+
Referral Closes	~50	~200	~930
Avg Fee Per Close	~$900	~$1,000	~$1,254
Partner Revenue	**$45K**	**$200K**	**$1.17M**
Partner Rev as % of Total	9%	18%	31%
Marginal Cost Per Close	**~$0**	**~$0**	**~$0**

SECTION 3 | RE-SCORING — 10-DIMENSION FRAMEWORK

Updated across four dimensions. The Partner Program materially improves Business Model, Competitive Landscape, Scalability, and Exit Potential.

#	Dimension	MVP Score	New Score	Δ	Rationale
1	Problem Severity & Urgency	9.5	**9.5**	—	Unchanged. Death and legacy planning remain irreversible, high-stakes decisions.
2	Market Size (TAM/SAM/SOM)	8.5	**9.0**	+0.5	Partner program opens B2B professional services TAM — $850B+ addressable market in estate, real estate, and financial services.
3	Unique Value Proposition	8.8	**9.2**	+0.4	Platform now bundles emotional legacy + professional services marketplace. No single competitor touches both.
4	Business Model & Revenue	8.5	**9.5**	+1.0	Dual revenue: $49/yr Annual + $149/yr Legacy subscription ($89 blended ARPU) AND partner referral fees (avg $1,254/close). Two independent growth levers.
5	Technology Moat	7.5	**8.0**	+0.5	Partner scoring algorithm (composite of transaction rate, satisfaction, response time, NPS) + user survey integration creates proprietary data flywheel.
6	Team Assessment	9.0	**9.0**	—	Unchanged. A Team of 10 domain experts remains exceptional for stage.
7	Competitive Landscape	7.8	**9.0**	+1.2	No competitor has a professional services marketplace with scored, vetted partners. B2B lock-in: partners who build pipelines through Solace Life have no reason to leave.
8	Scalability & Margins	8.5	**9.2**	+0.7	Partner revenue is near-zero marginal cost. Scales linearly with users. No extra headcount, no COGS. Gross margin 90%+ maintained or improved as partner mix grows.
9	Regulatory & Legal Risk	7.8	**7.8**	—	Referral fee model is standard commercial practice. No new regulatory surface area. Emma Walsh on retainer.
10	Exit Potential	9.2	**9.5**	+0.3	Financial services acquirers (MetLife, LegalZoom, Raymond James, major banks) now highly motivated. Platform with embedded professional marketplace commands strategic premium.
	OVERALL WEIGHTED SCORE	**9.2**	**9.5**	**+0.3**	**EXCEPTIONAL BUY — UPGRADED.** Dual revenue engine transforms the investment profile. Partner program adds 44% to Year 2 subscription ARR at near-zero cost.

SECTION 4 | SCORE PROGRESSION — THREE-STAGE COMPARISON

Concept Stage (8.0) → MVP Stage (9.2) → Partner Program Stage (9.5)

Dimension	Concept Stage	MVP Stage	Partner Stage	Total Lift
Problem Severity	9.5	9.5	**9.5**	0.0
Market Size	8.5	8.5	**9.0**	**+0.5**
Unique Value Prop	8.0	8.8	**9.2**	**+1.2**
Business Model	8.0	8.5	**9.5**	**+1.5**
Technology Moat	7.5	7.5	**8.0**	**+0.5**
Team	6.5	9.0	**9.0**	**+2.5**
Competitive	7.0	7.8	**9.0**	**+2.0**
Scalability	8.5	8.5	**9.2**	**+0.7**
Regulatory	6.0	7.8	**7.8**	**+1.8**
Exit Potential	9.0	9.2	**9.5**	**+0.5**
OVERALL	8.0	9.2	9.5	**+1.5**

Score Narrative: The Partner Program stage adds the most value to Business Model (+1.0), Competitive Landscape (+1.2 cumulative from concept), Scalability (+0.7), and Market Size (+0.5). These dimensions benefit directly from the dual revenue architecture. The total lift from concept to partner stage is +1.5 points — an exceptional improvement for a company at this stage. The score now approaches a 9.5 ceiling limited only by the outstanding patent filing (a condition for close, not a reflection of product quality).

8.0	9.2	9.5
Concept Stage Pre-MVP · Vision	MVP Stage Product Built · A Team	Partner Stage ✦ EXCEPTIONAL BUY Dual Revenue · Platform Moat

SECTION 5 | UPDATED FINANCIAL PROJECTIONS — DUAL REVENUE MODEL

Corrected pricing ($49/$149) with conservative partner program growth proportionate to user base.

Pricing Architecture (Corrected)

Tier	Price	Features	Target User
Free (30-Day Trial)	$0	5 memories, 1 family member, basic vault, app access	Trial / discovery
Annual	**$49/yr**	Unlimited memories, 10 family members, scheduled delivery, emergency contact	Core market — families 35–70
Legacy	**$149/yr**	Everything in Annual + estate planning tools, priority delivery, 180-day protected delivery	Affluent users, comprehensive planning

Blended ARPU: $89/yr (60% Annual × $49 + 40% Legacy × $149 = $89 weighted average)

Conservative Dual Revenue Projections

Metric	6 Months	Year 1	Year 2
Registered Users	20,000	50,000	150,000
Paying Subscribers (20% conv.)	5,000	10,000	30,000
Annual Plan ($49/yr)	3,000	6,000	18,000
Legacy Plan ($149/yr)	2,000	4,000	12,000
SUBSCRIPTION ARR	**$445K**	**$890K**	**$2.67M**
Partner Referral Closes	~50	~200	~930
PARTNER REVENUE	**$45K**	**$200K**	**$1.17M**
COMBINED REVENUE	**$490K**	**$1.09M**	**$3.84M**
Partner Rev as % of Total	9%	18%	31%
Gross Margin	**90%+**	**90%+**	**90%+**
YoY Revenue Growth	—	2.2×	3.5×

Analyst Note: Partner revenue grows from 9% of total revenue at Month 6 to 31% by Year 2. This is not a flat ratio — the partner program matures as the user base grows and partner relationships deepen. Year 1→Year 2 partner revenue grows 5.8× while subscription grows 3.0×. The partner program is the *faster-growing* revenue stream.

SECTION 6 | UPDATED RISK MATRIX

Partner Program mitigates two previously-identified risks and introduces one manageable new consideration.

Risk	Likelihood	Impact	Mitigation
Patent filing delay	**HIGH (current)**	MEDIUM	File provisional patent within 30 days of close — non-negotiable condition. Emergency contact + scheduled delivery + partner scoring algorithm are all patentable.
Low paid conversion	MEDIUM	MEDIUM ↓	**REDUCED by partner program.** Partners have financial incentive to drive Solace Life signups. Each partner close requires a paying user — creating a B2B acquisition channel with near-zero CAC.
Single revenue stream failure	**LOW ↓↓**	HIGH → LOW	**ELIMINATED.** Dual revenue engine means subscription slowdown is offset by partner program growth and vice versa. Two independent growth levers.
Competitor response	LOW	MEDIUM	Partner scoring system + user data moat cannot be replicated without the user base. Emergency contact IP should be filed immediately. Category remains uncrowded.
Partner quality / brand risk	LOW	MEDIUM	Partner scoring system (composite of transaction rate, satisfaction, response time, NPS) enforces quality floor. Partners below minimum score are suspended. Self-policing mechanism.
App Store / Google Play approval	MEDIUM	HIGH	Submit to both stores within 30 days. Build review buffer into timeline. React Native compatibility confirmed.
Big-tech entry (Apple, Google)	MEDIUM	HIGH	First-mover emotional trust + partner ecosystem. Apple has Medical ID but no memory scheduling or partner marketplace. File IP and build partner moat first.
Churn	LOW	MEDIUM	Emotional lock-in is the strongest churn defense in consumer SaaS. Users do not delete the app holding their family's voice recordings. Partner relationships create additional stickiness.

SECTION 7 | UPDATED VALUATION PROGRESSION

Dual revenue engine commands higher multiples at each stage. Financial services acquirers now in play.

Stage	Milestone	Valuation	Key Drivers
STAGE 1 (Complete)	Concept	$1.5M–$2.5M	Original SAFE recommendation — now closed
STAGE 2 (Complete)	Working MVP	$5.0M–$6.5M	Full production app · A Team · Live infrastructure · Founding member program
STAGE 3 (CURRENT)	**Partner Program Active**	**$6.0M–$8.0M**	Dual revenue engine · Partner scoring system · 5 verticals active · $3.84M Year 2 combined projection
STAGE 4	6-Month Traction	$18M–$26M	1,000–2,500 paid subscribers · ARR $800K–$1.1M · First 50+ partner closes · B2B pilot signed
STAGE 5	Year 2 Full Scale	$46M–$77M	30,000 paying users · $2.67M Sub ARR · $1.17M Partner Revenue · $3.84M Combined · EBITDA positive
STAGE 6	Strategic Exit / IPO	$250M–$500M	$40M+ Combined ARR · Apple/MetLife/LegalZoom/major bank acquisition · Financial services premium multiple

Strategic Acquirer Landscape — Expanded by Partner Program

Acquirer Type	Motivation	Estimated Acquisition Interest
Apple (Apple Legacy)	Emergency contact system + iOS integration + family vault	HIGH — feature acquisition or full buy
LegalZoom / Willful	Estate planning funnel + attorney referral network (direct overlap)	VERY HIGH — direct strategic fit
MetLife / Sun Life	Life insurance policyholder engagement + beneficiary data	HIGH — insurance bundle + partner revenue complement
Royal Bank / Major Bank	Estate banking + financial planner referral channel (15% fee model)	MEDIUM-HIGH — partner program is a trust funnel for banking
Remax / Coldwell Banker	Realtor referral program (20% fee) is the single largest revenue vertical	HIGH — $468K Year 2 revenue from their market

SECTION 8 | UPDATED TERM SHEET — SEED ROUND

Pre-money valuation stepped up from $5.5M to $6.0M reflecting the partner program's structural impact on revenue quality.

OFFER 3 (REVISED) | POST-MVP + PARTNER PROGRAM — SEED PRICED ROUND
INVESTMENT: $1.5M – $2.0M | PRE-MONEY VALUATION: $6.0M | EQUITY: 20–25% | STRUCTURE: Seed Preferred
Valuation stepped up from $5.5M (MVP stage) to $6.0M on Partner Program activation and revenue diversification.

Term	Detail
Instrument	Series Seed Preferred Stock (Priced Round)
Investment Amount	$1,500,000 – $2,000,000
Pre-Money Valuation	**$6,000,000 (up from $5.5M MVP stage — reflects dual revenue engine)**
Post-Money Valuation	$7.5M – $8.0M
Equity Stake	20% – 25% (fully diluted)
Liquidation Preference	1x non-participating preferred
Anti-Dilution	Broad-based weighted average
Board Composition	2 founders, 1 lead investor, 1 independent
Information Rights	Monthly financial statements (subscription ARR + partner revenue separately reported); quarterly investor calls
Use of Funds	App Store launch, founding member marketing, patent filings, partner program expansion, B2B pilot program, 18-month runway
Milestones Required	1,000 paid subscribers, ARR > $400K, provisional patent filed, App Store live, 10+ active partners within 6 months

Investor Return Highlights:

Scenario	Exit Valuation	Return on $1.5M Investment	Return on $2.0M Investment
Conservative (8× ARR, Year 2)	$30.7M	~4.1× ($6.1M)	~3.8× ($7.7M)
Base Case (12× ARR, Year 2)	$46.1M	~6.1× ($9.2M)	~5.8× ($11.5M)
Strategic Exit (LegalZoom/MetLife)	**$250M–$500M**	**33–67× ($50M–$100M)**	**25–50× ($50M–$100M)**

SECTION 9 | FINAL RECOMMENDATION

Third evaluation. Each stage has exceeded the prior bar. This is now one of the strongest pre-seed opportunities this committee has reviewed.

VERDICT: EXCEPTIONAL BUY — UPGRADED FROM 9.2 TO 9.5

We recommend a Seed Round investment of $1.5M–$2.0M at a $6.0M pre-money valuation.

Three times this committee has reviewed Solace Life. Three times the founder has exceeded expectations. At concept stage, we were investing in a vision. At MVP stage, we were investing in a product. Today, we are investing in a **platform** — a dual-revenue business with two independent growth engines, a B2B moat through a scored professional services marketplace, and an expanding universe of strategic acquirers.

The Partner Referral Program is not a feature. It is a structural transformation. Subscription revenue ($89 blended ARPU, 90%+ margin) compounds with partner revenue (~$1,254 per close, near-zero marginal cost) to create a combined Year 2 revenue of **$3.84M** — 44% more than subscription alone. Critically, these two streams are *not correlated*: subscription converts individual users, while partner revenue activates when those users take real-world financial action. One monetizes the platform. The other monetizes the decisions the platform enables.

The score upgrade from 9.2 to **9.5** reflects four materially improved dimensions: Business Model (+1.0), Competitive Landscape (+1.2 cumulative), Scalability (+0.7), and Market Size (+0.5). The partner scoring system — combining transaction completion rate, user satisfaction surveys, response time, and NPS — is itself a proprietary data asset that improves with scale. This is a moat that compounds.

The one outstanding item from our previous conditions — patent filing — must be addressed before close. This is non-negotiable. The emergency contact feature, the scheduled delivery engine, and the partner scoring algorithm are all patentable. File a provisional within 30 days.

Conditions for This Round

1	Provisional patent filing within 30 days of close — emergency contact system + scheduled delivery engine + partner scoring algorithm
2	App Store (iOS) and Google Play submission within 30 days of close
3	First 100 founding member subscriptions activated within 60 days
4	10+ active vetted partners onboarded within 60 days (at least 3 verticals)
5	Monthly KPI reporting: subscribers, subscription ARR, partner closes, partner revenue, CAC, churn, NPS

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EXCEPTIONAL BUY

SOLACE LIFE — PARTNER PROGRAM RE-REVIEW — MAY 2026

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